

Tree Replacement Fee

San Mateo Municipal Code Chapter 27.71 establishes a fee on all development requiring approval of a planning application, except for Single-Family Dwelling Design Review (SFDDR) applications, for the removal of existing trees on development sites. The fee is imposed if the trees to be removed are not made up with replacement trees on-site.

Under San Mateo Municipal Code Chapter 13.35, the City may also impose a fee on any person or entity for removing trees that encroach on City streets. The fee is imposed if the tree(s) to be removed are not replanted with a like tree satisfying City requirements. The fee is to be used by the City for plantings on public land. As shown in the 2024-25 Comprehensive Fee Schedule, effective January 1, 2025, the fee charged is as follows:

Tree Replacement Cost:	
24 inch Box Tree	\$805 per tree
15 gallon Tree	\$503 per tree
36 inch Box Tree	\$1,593 per tree
8 inch Box Tree	\$3,217 per tree

The following table shows activities in 2024-25.

Tree Replacement Fee	2024-25
Beginning Balance	1,132,343
Prior Year Adjustments	-
Developer Fees	297,649
Interest Income / (Expense)	410,166
Expenditures	(97,366)
Ending Balance	\$ 1,742,792

2024-25			
Tree Replacement Fee	Total Expended	In-Lieu Fees Used	% of Total
Project Expenditures:			
610008 Tree Planting - Parks Division	\$ 99,766	\$ 97,366	98%
Total Expenditures:	\$ 99,766	\$ 97,366	98%

The total ending balance as of the end of fiscal year was \$1,742,792. The fund balance and continued collection of the Tree Replacement Fee will be utilized to fund the project(s) listed in Exhibit A.

Below Market Rate Housing Fee

The Below Market Rate Housing Fee, which became effective January 1, 2010 pursuant to City Council Resolution No. 121 (2008), is collected from developers in lieu of constructing affordable housing units onsite as required under the City's Below Market Rate program. The fee applies to developments that contain fewer than 11 residential units, and to fractional unit requirements of less than .5 for developments that contain 11 or more units. The fee is charged as shown in the 2024-25 Comprehensive Fee Schedule: